VisionQuest Finale Finally Wraps Up Ultron's Story

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Spoiler warning: this article talks about the season finale of 'VisionQuest.'

An argument could be made that the 'VisionQuest' finale was a confrontation over a decade in the making. The Disney+ series has marketed itself as a 'WandaVision' sequel and a **trilogy**-capper to the story continued in 'Agatha All Along.' But its biggest job was providing a fitting ending to the 2015 blockbuster 'Avengers: Age of Ultron.'

In an inspired choice, **showrunner** Terry Matalas understood there was still plenty of unfinished business between James Spader's robot Ultron and Paul Bettany's **synthezoid** Vision a **synthezoid** is an artificial being. That unfinished business finally pays off in the eighth and final episode of the show.

Once Vision and Jocasta (T'Nia Miller) realize that the mysterious Client dogging their steps is actually Virgil Horton (also played by Spader), the descendant of Phineas Horton, the mind behind the Synthetic Man, this sets up the finale's most compelling battle. No, it is not Horton's twisted love for Dr. Jo Carrington and his desire to inhabit Vision's body so they may live forever together. It is the apparent murder of Ultron's lover Jocasta, setting off Ultron's anger toward humanity and one last showdown with Vision.

This is the kind of potential that shared universes were meant to fully realize not cameos and references for the sake of it, but meaningful additions to ongoing stories for viewers willing to take the time to explore them. That may go down as the greatest accomplishment of 'VisionQuest' in its finale, delivering the perfect ending to the Ultron saga that 'Age of Ultron' simply could not pull off.

Amazing what eight hours of storytelling can do that a single movie never could. The film still managed to find moments of quiet poignancy amid all the spectacle, and Matalas and his writers have carried that over into 'VisionQuest,' nowhere more confidently than in the finale.

We are not only talking about the moment when a dying Jocasta merges Ultron with a horde of killer nanobots and allows him to regain his physical form, fighting Vision in a well-staged battle. What puts the finale over the top is when it combines the best of 'Age of Ultron' with 'WandaVision.' Vision traps Ultron inside a sitcom-set **mindscape** where the two artificial beings can hash out their differences without throwing hands and trading particle beams at each other. It brings us back to their best moment of all when, in the midst of Sokovia's destruction, the two land in an idyllic forest to talk about humanity's doomed fate, the grace found in their failings, and the fact that nothing beautiful is meant to last forever.

Here, the big climactic fight becomes a look at Ultron's all-consuming grief, his anger toward human beings, and, deep down, his fear of being alone.

If we let 'Avengers: Age of Ultron' have the final word on the robot, then Ultron's arc is a tragic one. Designed to save humanity, he instead opts to facilitate our wholesale destruction and finally achieve 'peace in our time.' He does learn to become surprisingly more human over the course of the film, but his last act is a refusal to grant humankind the benefit of the doubt.

To the credit of 'VisionQuest,' this season-long **epilogue** suggests there is more to his emotional journey than a single movie could ever explore. The finale digs even deeper, completing Ultron's transformation into something much more human by giving him someone to love. Despite the changes made to the comics' origins, the Ultron/Jocasta romance is a defining moment in Ultron's portrayal. Finally, he can understand Vision's own progression to becoming an individual in his own right, along with all the joy and loss and humanity that comes with it.

That is probably why, even after he retreats back to his old ways and attempts to cause our extinction again, 'VisionQuest' suggests that Ultron is not beyond **redemption**. It is not until he is confronted with his own mortality that he finally decides to spare the world's population. But even that is as human as it gets. Vision helps him come to terms with what life has to offer. And when we leave him, eager to appreciate human art and perhaps even rebuild Jocasta, it is a perfect ending... or, perhaps, an ellipsis.

'VisionQuest' is now streaming on Disney+ in its entirety.

Word Treasure

synthezoid -- A synthezoid is an artificial being, like a robot that looks human.
showrunner -- A showrunner is the person in charge of making a TV show.
mindscape -- A mindscape is a world inside someone's mind.
epilogue -- An epilogue is a final part that wraps up a story.
redemption -- Redemption means being saved or forgiven after doing wrong.
trilogy -- A trilogy is a set of three connected stories.

Background you need

The Marvel Cinematic Universe is a series of connected movies and shows where characters and stories carry over from one to the next.

Avengers: Age of Ultron is a 2015 movie about Ultron, a robot built to save humanity who instead turned against it.

Vision is an artificial being who became his own person, learning about joy, loss, and what it means to be human.

VisionQuest is a Disney+ series that continues Vision's story and finishes the long-running tale of Ultron and Vision.

Break it down

LEAD: The 'VisionQuest' finale settles a story that began more than ten years ago in 'Avengers: Age of Ultron.'

KEY EVENT: In the eighth and final episode, Vision and Jocasta learn the Client is Virgil Horton, setting up a last showdown with Ultron.

+- WHO: Vision (Paul Bettany), Ultron (James Spader), Jocasta (T'Nia Miller), and Virgil Horton (James Spader)

+- WHAT: A final battle that becomes a talk inside a sitcom-style mindscape

+- WHEN: The finale of the eight-episode Disney+ series

EVIDENCE: Ultron's grief, fear of being alone, and love for Jocasta make him more human.

OPEN QUESTION: Will Ultron rebuild Jocasta, and what comes next for Vision?

Why it matters

Stories about heroes and villains help us think about big feelings like grief, loneliness, and forgiveness -- and whether anyone is beyond saving.

Test what you remember

1. What story does the 'VisionQuest' finale finish?

- (A) The story of the first Avengers movie
- (B) A story that began in 'WandaVision'
- (C) A story from the comics about Spider-Man
- (D) A story that began in the 2015 movie 'Avengers: Age of Ultron'

2. Who is the mysterious Client?

- (A) A new Avenger
- (B) Virgil Horton, a descendant of Phineas Horton
- (C) Dr. Jo Carrington
- (D) Ultron in disguise

3. What does Vision do to Ultron in the most surprising scene?

- (A) He sends Ultron into space
- (B) He turns Ultron into a human
- (C) He destroys Ultron with a laser
- (D) He traps Ultron inside a sitcom-style mindscape so they can talk

4. What does the finale give Ultron that he never had before?

- (A) A seat on the Avengers
- (B) Someone to love
- (C) A trip back in time
- (D) A new army of robots

5. What does Ultron choose to do when he faces his own mortality?

- (A) He spares the world's population
- (B) He destroys the world
- (C) He runs away to another planet
- (D) He erases his own memory

6. Who is the showrunner of 'VisionQuest'?

- (A) James Spader
- (B) Terry Matalas
- (C) Paul Bettany
- (D) James Gunn

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: D 2: B 3: D 4: B 5: A 6: B

Questions to think about

1. **Showrunner Terry Matalas: Understood there was unfinished business between Ultron and Vision and used eight hours of TV to finish it.**

2. **The /Film writers: Say the finale delivers the perfect ending to the Ultron story that one movie could not.**

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):